MMS / EQUIPMENT BUYING GUIDE

Point-of-care testing buying guide

Buy a result the clinic needs soon enough to change its work. Test menus, temperature limits and usable pack quantities decide the recurring cost.

START HERE

For a small clinic, first fund sustainable hemoglobin, professional glucose and urine workflows. Hb 301 deserves a warm-site comparison because its stated operating and cuvette-storage range is 10-40°C.

CONSIDER ALTERNATIVES WHEN

For urgent blood gases/basic chemistry, compare epoc with the required i-STAT cartridges. Piccolo fits routine chemistry with refrigerated discs. Add DCA Vantage when sustained demand justifies its assay and control program.

WATCH THE BUDGET

epoc cards require 15-30°C storage; Piccolo discs require 2-8°C. Include delivery conditions, expiry, controls and repeats. A low pack price means little if quiet weeks leave much of it unused.

CHECK THE SUPPORT

Verify exact reader, reagent and software compatibility. The reviewed October 2026 Nova action concerned specified Gen 2.0 models and an unresolved remedy, not every StatStrip device.

THREE QUESTIONS FOR THE SUPPLIER

1. Which exact assays, sample types and patients does this package cover?

2. What pack sizes, arrival expiry and control consumption should we budget?

3. Can our delivery and storage conditions meet every consumable's limits?

Selected sources: HemoCue · Siemens Healthineers · Siemens Healthineers

Read the full guide, model comparisons and source notes online →

Reviewed 2026-10-16 · Purchasing guidance; confirm the exact unit, local requirements and support before ordering.